

START HERE

How to talk along

- 1 Pick a card that fits the moment.
- 2 Read it out loud.
- 3 Everyone answers, grown-ups too.
- 4 "Pass" is always allowed.

 Dinner

 Car

 Bath

 Bedtime



In the car, a passenger reads. The driver just talks.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 01

**What was the best
part of your day?
What was the trickiest
part?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Go first with yours. Kids open up when grown-ups share too.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 02

If you could invent a brand-new food, what would be in it? What would you call it?



GROWN-UP TIP

Play along with silly answers. Silly keeps the talk going.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 03

Who made you smile today? What did they do?



GROWN-UP TIP

Listen for new names and ask one more question about them.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 04

If our family had a holiday that was just ours, what would we do on it?



GROWN-UP TIP

Write down the best idea, and try it for real.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 05

What's something you're getting better at?



GROWN-UP TIP

Notice the effort: "You kept practicing."



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 06

**If you could have dinner
with any animal, which
one would you pick?
What would you talk
about?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask one follow-up question before
you share your own answer.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 07

**What's one thing
you'd love to learn
how to do?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what the very first step might be.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 08

If you were in charge of the house for a day, what rule would you make?



GROWN-UP TIP

Skip the correcting. Ask, “Why that rule?”



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 09

What's a question you've always wanted to ask me?



GROWN-UP TIP

Answer honestly and briefly, then
ask it back.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 10

What made you laugh this week?



GROWN-UP TIP

Laugh along. Retelling a funny moment is storytelling practice.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 11

**If you had a
superpower just for
helping people, what
would it be?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask who they would help first.



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 12

**Describe your
perfect weekend,
from breakfast to
bedtime.**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for details: “What would it smell like? Sound like?”



Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 13

**What's something
kind that someone
did for you lately?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Say thanks for sharing. It doesn't
need to become a lesson.



5-12 • 14

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Would you rather
drive a bus, fly a
plane or sail a boat?
Why?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Side-by-side talk feels easy. Eyes on the road is fine.



5-12 • 15

Car

A PASSENGER READS

Pick someone you can see outside. Make up a story about where they're going.



GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one sentence each.



5-12 • 16

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**If this car could take
us anywhere in one
second, where would
we go?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they would pack.



5-12 • 17

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What song should
be our family's
theme song?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Let them pick the next song and ask why they like it.



5-12 • 18

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What's something
you're looking
forward to?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Share something you're looking forward to as well.



5-12 · 19

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**If you designed a
playground, what
would it have?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to describe it so clearly
you could draw it.



Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 • 20

Pick a color. How many things that color can we spot before we get there?



GROWN-UP TIP

Count out loud together. Younger kids can point.



5-12 • 21

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What would you do if
you were the grown-
up and I were the kid
today?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Laugh along, then ask what they'd
do the same as you.



5-12 · 22

Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What's the hardest
part of being a kid
right now?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Just listen. “That sounds hard” is enough.



Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 • 23

What's a game, show or video you like right now? What's the best part?



GROWN-UP TIP

Be curious, not a critic. Ask them to explain it to you.



Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 24

**Tell me about a
dream you
remember.**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they think it meant. There are no wrong answers.



Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 • 25

**What's something
you know a lot
about? Teach me
one thing.**



GROWN-UP TIP

Be the curious student. Ask a real question.



Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 • 26

Think of an animal. I'll ask yes-or-no questions until I guess it.



GROWN-UP TIP

Swap roles so they practice asking the questions.



5-12 • **27**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**If you could swim with
any sea creature,
which one would you
choose?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what it would feel like to touch it.



5-12 • **28**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

What would a fish say about our bathtub?



GROWN-UP TIP

Answer back in your best fish voice.



5-12 • **29**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**What felt hard
today? What
helped?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Warm water and a calm voice make this a gentle time to ask.



5-12 • **30**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**If a bubble could carry
a message anywhere,
what would yours
say?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Blow the message away together.



5-12 • **31**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**What's your favorite
smell in the whole
world? Why?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Share yours. Smells often bring back stories.



5-12 • **32**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**If you were a
raindrop, where
would you want to
land?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask, “And then what happens?”



5-12 • **33**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

Invent a new bath toy. What does it do?



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to give it a name and a sound.



Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • **34**

What makes someone a good friend?



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for an example from their day.



5-12 • **35**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**Would you rather
live under the sea or
up in the clouds?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask about the trickiest part of living there.



5-12 • **36**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

You just found a new planet. What's its name, and who lives there?



GROWN-UP TIP

Build the world together, one detail each.



5-12 • **37**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**What's something
you like about
yourself?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Leave a pause. Then share
something you like about them.



5-12 • **38**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**Close your eyes.
How many sounds
can you hear right
now?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Listen quietly first, then compare lists.



5-12 • **39**

Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

If you shrank to the size of a rubber duck, what would you explore?



GROWN-UP TIP

Follow their lead and keep asking, “Then what?”



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **40**

What are three good things from today?



GROWN-UP TIP

Keep it small. A snack, a joke or a sunny minute all count.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **41**

What's something you're wondering about?



GROWN-UP TIP

**"I don't know. Let's find out
tomorrow" is a great answer.**



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **42**

**If you could choose
tonight's dream,
what would it be?**



GROWN-UP TIP

**Speak slowly and softly. Calm voices
help everyone wind down.**



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **43**

Who is someone you're thankful for? Why?



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask if they'd like to tell that person tomorrow.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **44**

**What was a brave
thing you did this
week?**



GROWN-UP TIP

**Name the feeling: “You felt nervous,
and you did it anyway.”**



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 · **45**

What's your favorite memory of our family?



GROWN-UP TIP

Share one of your favorite memories
of them.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **46**

**If your stuffed animal
could talk, what would
it say about your day?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Let the toy answer in its own voice.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **47**

**What's something
you'd like to do
together this
weekend?**



GROWN-UP TIP

**Pick one idea and put it on the
calendar.**



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 · **48**

**Was there
anything that
worried you
today?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Listen first. Solutions can wait until morning.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **49**

Start a story: “Once upon a time, a tiny dragon...”



GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one line until someone yawns.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • 50

**What would you love
to be really good at
when you grow up?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they love about it.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **51**

**If today were weather,
what would it be?
Sunny, cloudy,
stormy?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Accept every answer. Feelings aren't right or wrong.



Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **52**

**What do you want
to remember
about today?**



GROWN-UP TIP

End with the same goodnight words every night.

MAKE IT YOURS



Your own question

OUR QUESTION



GROWN-UP TIP

For:

Dinner

Car

Bath

Bedtime